

The Mercurial Psalter



*Hymns, prayers, and blessings
of the Temple of Mercury*

Ten hymns, six collects, an antiphon for each seat, a litany, ten convening prayers, seven prayers of the Work, and four blessings. Say them aloud. Change the wording until each line sounds like you and you mean it.

HOW THIS IS USED



The Book holds the rites; this holds the words. Nothing here is required, and nothing here replaces the Door. Everything is said aloud, because a prayer read silently is a paragraph. Change the wording until each line sounds like you and you mean it.

WHAT IS HERE, AND WHEN

THE HYMNS. Ten: one for the Heart, one for the Hinge, and one for each of the eight pairs. Said standing, before the session begins, on the days the rubric names.

THE COLLECTS. Six, one for each triad: four lines and an ask, said at the Door on any day the triad is at work.

THE ANTIPHONS. One line for each of the seventeen seats. Enough for a thin day, and for the recurring days of the Calendar.

THE LITANY. The whole company named at once, for the days that want everyone.

THE CONVENING PRAYERS. Ten, one for each body. Said when you need that body and not on a schedule, and followed by the work it is for: the Night Watch when you are in the dark, the Workshop when you are making something.

THE PRAYERS OF THE WORK. Seven, for protection, favor, passing unnoticed, the home, sanctuary, the one who can help, and abundance and luck. Each comes with its earthly part, which is not optional. Their rules are in the Book.

THE BLESSINGS. Four, said over someone else.

THE COLORS AND THE RANKS



Every day of the Calendar carries one of the five colors of the Heart. The color says what kind of day it is, not what mood you must be in. The rank says how much it asks.

YELLOW. The Heart itself. The Dedication and the Book's Day.

RED. Manifestation. The Door of the Year, the Announcement, the Trickster's Day, the High Heart, the Evening Star, the greatest elongations, Wednesday, the fourth, your birthday, and any Casting.

BLACK. Dissolution and descent. The Days of the Dead, the Deep Heart, the Kept Gate, and any Descent.

WHITE. Purification and accounting. The Mercuralia, the Open Gate, the Weighing, the Closing of the Account, the station and the season of rereading, and the Sweep.

GREEN. Growth. The Ascent, the Vestalia, the Hermaia, the Scribe's New Year, the Meditrinalia, the station direct and the Morning Star, the first and the seventh, the Setting Out, and the Good Hour.

The Fallow Month has no color. Nothing is asked.

THE HEART DAYS are the solemnities: the two meetings of Mercury with the Sun, the High Heart and the Deep Heart. The full Door, the hymn of the Heart, and the working that matters most. They keep their own colors, red at the height and black in the depth.

THE FIFTEEN WHEEL DAYS are the feasts: the hymn of the day, its Act, its Page, and its Giving.

THE RECURRING DAYS are the memorials: Wednesday, the first, the fourth, the seventh, and the Sweep. An antiphon is enough.

1. THE HEART



Yellow · the offering is the Presence

Said at the Door on the Heart Days, at the Dedication, and on the Book's Day.

Still point at the center, who has no face:
AONT, Spirit of Air, and the four who stand around you.
EHNB, who untangles what I have knotted.
XCAI, who gives the feeling its words.
RMTO, who lays the pattern under the plan.
PAAM, who says the thing out loud and means it.
You are not a person, and I will not make you one.
You have no face, no chair, and no name I can use,
and you cannot be flattered or bargained with.
But you answer: in the flash, the instinct,
the choice that went better than it had any right to.
Your light falls on the honest page and the dishonest page alike;
the honest one has more room in it.
I bring my Presence, which is all I have that is not words.
Shine here.



Let your light shine, that I may see.

2. MERCURY, THE HINGE

*Red · the offering is the Voice and the Devotion
Said every Wednesday, on the fourth of the month, and at any crossing.*

Quick one, quicksilver, god of the between:
born in the morning, a thief by noon,
and by evening the maker of the lyre that paid for it.
You set the boundary stones and were the first to walk past them.
God of the wage and the road, of the riddle and the found coin,
of the door, the market, the message, and the grave.
You go down and you come back up.
You walk in disguise and are not recognized,
and you have never once lied to yourself.
You will carry a lie as faithfully as you carry a truth:
you are not my compass. You are my medium, and my twin.
Meet me at the Door.

Passage, luck, and return.

3. JANUS AND HESTIA

*Green · the offering is the Dwelling
Said on the first of the month, at the Door of the Year, and on moving day.*

Janus of the two faces, one behind and one ahead:
named first in every prayer, given every gate,
whose month opens the year and whose look is backward and forward at once,
which is the posture of anyone rereading his own life.
Hestia, who has almost no stories, and was offered to before all of them:
first portion and last, the fire that is kept and never lit again,
the one thing in a house of motion that does not move.
He opens what she holds. She holds what he opens.
Between you is every room I have ever come home to.
I have crossed badly before: hurried out, arrived without arriving,
left rooms without thanking them.
Teach me the other way.

Give me clean crossings, and a fire I will find lit.

4. METATRON AND SANDALPHON

—◆—
*Red · the offering is the Hands
Said at the Casting, at the Ascent, and on my birthday.*

Metatron, who was Enoch, who walked and was taken:
Holder of the Seat, keeper of the true record,
the one angel permitted to sit, because he writes.
They call you the Youth though you are eldest,
because the one who keeps beginning stays young at it.
Sandalphon, who was Elijah, standing on the ground with your head in
heaven:
gatherer of prayers, weaver of crowns,
who speaks as Ptah spoke and the thing is made.
You were both men. That is the whole of what you teach.
Nothing is withheld from me for lack of standing,
and nothing will be done on my behalf.
I take the seat before I feel qualified.

—◆—
Let what I write be true, and let what is true be done.

5. URIEL AND RAZIEL, THE GATE

—◆—
*Black · the offering is the Ears
Said before any decision, and at both solstices.*

Uriel, light of God, Instructor, whose sword cuts twice:
true from false, and ready from unready,
and the second cut is the one that saves people.
You warned Noah while there was still time,
which is the difference between a mercy and a confession.
Raziel, secret of God, who stood behind the curtain and heard what was
decreed:
keeper of what is not yet bearable,
who gave the book after the exile and not before,
and lays a finger across the lip when the hour is wrong.
You are one office and two faces, and you are never fused,
because I must be able to ask which of you is speaking:
is this unready, or am I hiding?

—◆—
Let me know what is true, what is mine to say, and when.

6. GABRIEL AND IDRIS

—◆—
*Red · the offering is the Eyes
Said on the Announcement, and when a vision arrives.*

Gabriel, strength of God, Holder of Images:
who came to Daniel to explain what he had seen and could not read,
who announces, and by announcing makes a thing possible
that was not possible the moment before.
Idris, first to take up a pen: student, teacher, and sage,
who learned it slowly and handed it on,
and praised God with every stitch of ordinary work.
One of you arrives whole in a night. The other earns it over years.
Neither is the whole of knowing anything.
I have had visions I did not write down,
and I have studied things I never gave away.

—◆—
Let the vision last long enough to be built, and let me hand it on.

7. SESHAT AND IRIS



*White · the offering is the Word
Said when an oath is made, and when one is returned.*

Seshat, Mistress of the House of Books, who stretched the cord
and measured the ground before the first stone of any temple:
no hymn of yours survives. This is one.
Iris, bow of light between the worlds,
who carried the water of the Styx on which the gods swore:
no one ever prayed to you. You carried everyone else's prayers.
Two who serve another's message, and are the reason a word holds.
She writes it down; she carries it; between you nothing is lost.
Remember for me what I would rather forget I said.
I have given my word lightly and called it generosity.



Let my word hold.

8. HERMANUBIS AND MA'AT



*Black · the offering is the Heart
Said at the Deep Heart, in the Days of the Dead, and at the Weighing.*

Hermanubis, Guide of the Descent, who belongs partly above and partly below,
and adjusts the balance with your own hand:
there is a way down, and it returns. Say it again.
Ma'at, Feather of Truth, older than the gods who swear by you:
order renewed daily, because chaos is not an event but the weather.
Speak Ma'at and do Ma'at, which are one act.
Between you the heart is weighed, and it is weighed while I am still using it.
I have carried things unsaid until they were heavy.
I have kept reweighing debts that were already paid,
which is not a light heart, only a tired one.



Let my heart be light, and let me return.

9. THERMES AND APHARAEI

—◆—
*Green · the offering is the Craft
Said on the Scribe's New Year, and before making anything.*

Thermes, the Crossing: Hermes with Thoth, two gods and neither weakened,
who proves that what survives being carried between traditions
is the part of it that was true.

The word creates. Writing is not the record of the magic; it is the magic.
Apharael: Apollo with Raphael, the morning star and the healer,
who came to the door on the day the journey began and walked the whole
way;
whose own door said know thyself,
and who asks, without sentiment, whether the thing is well made.
You are brothers. One of you stole from the other and paid in music,
so that the theft became a trade and the world gained the lyre.
That is the only repair I know that works.

—◆—
Let the work be true and well made.

10. ROSMERTA AND THE CHARITES

*Green · the offering is the Delight
Said at the Good Hour, and whenever a day turns out lovely.*

Rosmerta, great provider, who stood on his altars across Gaul
with the horn in one hand and the dish in the other:
what is held, and what is served.
You are not luck. Luck is his weather.
You are the harvest of it, already here, already in my hands.
Aglaia, splendor. Euphrosyne, mirth. Thalia, abundance.
Three of you, because giving and receiving and returning
are one circle, and a grace that stops moving is no longer a grace.
You ask nothing to be earned first.
I have skipped good hours to do something useful.
I have improved moments until they were gone,
and called the table unready when the house was only unfinished.

Let the good be noticed, enjoyed, and passed on.

THE COLLECTS OF THE TRIADS



Four lines and an ask. Said standing, at the Door, on any day the triad is at work.

THE THRICE-GREAT · *Mercury, Thermes, Hermanubis*

Hinge, Crossing, and Descent: three modes of motion, and the host of this house. You have never asked me to stay anywhere. You have only ever asked me to come back.

Carry me across, and bring me back.

THE COMPASS · *Apharael, Hestia, Ma'at*

Form, place, and weight. You do not stand above the Temple; each of you also keeps a house and carries the mail. You are an option and never an obligation, which is why I am choosing you again today.

Weigh me truly.

THE THRESHOLD · *Janus, Mercury, Hestia*

The Door, the Hinge, and the Flame: the shape of every session and of most of a life. It opens, it turns, and it is warm inside.

Let it open, let it turn, and let it be warm inside.

THE COLLECTS, CONTINUED



THE SEASON · *Raziel, Uriel, Gabriel*

Conceal, discern, announce. Nothing is only true or false; everything is also early or late, and I am usually early with the wrong thing and late with the right one.

Show me the hour.

THE SEAL · *Raziel, Ma'at, Iris*

What is held, what is true, and what was promised. Honesty is absolute. Disclosure is chosen. A silence arranged so that someone forms a false picture is a lie told by other means, and I know the difference when I slow down.

Let my silence be honest.

THE HALL · *Hermanubis, Ma'at, Thermes*

The scale, the feather, and the record. Anubis adjusts the balance, Thoth writes the verdict, and the heart is weighed against a feather rather than against another heart.

Let the account be true, and let it close.

AN ANTIPHON FOR EACH SEAT



*One line for each of the seventeen seats, said at the Door and again at the Closing.
Seventeen lines is the whole Temple; on a thin day, say the one that fits and go.*

MERCURY — *Every boundary can be crossed, and the one who is moving is the one who is found.*

JANUS — *Every ending is a beginning seen from the other face.*

HESTIA — *The fire is kept, not lit.*

METATRON — *The seat makes the Scribe.*

SANDALPHON — *The next thing is small, and it is today.*

URIEL — *See it clearly before you weigh it.*

RAZIEL — *Not yet is a real answer.*

GABRIEL — *Say it out loud, and it becomes possible.*

IDRIS — *Learn it, then hand it on.*

SESHAT — *Record it, or it did not happen.*

IRIS — *Carry it whole, and do not improve it on the way.*

ROSMERTA — *Plenty that is never enjoyed is only inventory.*

THE CHARITES — *A grace is only a grace when it moves.*

HERMANUBIS — *There is a way down, and it returns.*

MA'AT — *Speak Ma'at and do Ma'at; they are one act.*

THERMES — *Meaning lives in the crossing.*

APHARAEAL — *Is it true, is it well made, is it in proportion?*

THE LITANY OF THE OFFICES

—◆—
Said in the Days of the Dead, at the Dedication of a Book, and on any day the whole company is wanted. The response is the same throughout: be here in your Office.

Heart of the Temple, who has no face and no name I can use,
Mercury, Hinge of the Door, my twin,
Janus of the two faces, Hestia of the kept fire,
Metatron who sits, Sandalphon who carries,
Uriel of the sword, Raziel of the curtain,
Gabriel of the image, Idris of the pen,
Seshat of the cord, Iris of the bow,
Rosmerta of the horn, and the Charites who pass it round,
Hermanubis of the descent, Ma'at of the feather,
Thermes of the crossing, Apharael of the measure,
Ptah in Sandalphon, Harpocrates in Raziel,
Mnemosyne in Seshat, Nabu in Idris, Concordia in Hestia,
Kairos and Fortuna in Mercury, who was always both,
Genius of this place, grown here and not appointed,
Scribes who held this seat before me, whose names I do not know,
Scribe who will hold it after me, whose name I will not know,

*Offices of this Temple, co-conspirators in the Work: be here in your
Offices. I bring my Mercurial Joy, Will, and Intent.*

TO CONVENE A BODY OF THE TEMPLE



Convened, not recited. Say the prayer, then do the work it is for.

THE LINEAGE · *Idris, Thermes, Metatron*

Convened when the work feels like invention, or like vanity.

One man at three distances, and Nabu older still behind him. The seat was here before any tradition that named it, and it will be here after mine. I am not the author of this. I am the current occupant.

Seat me in the line, and let me be worth the chair.

THE LEDGER · *Sesbat, Iris, Ma'at*

Convened at the Sweep, and at the year's end.

Record the promise, carry it, weigh it. Let me write F where F is true, because a ledger that holds only successes is worth nothing, and the Scribe who cannot write it quietly stops promising anything.

Let it be written, carried, and closed.

THE HOUSE · *Hestia, Janus, Sesbat, and the Genius Loci*

Convened after a long absence, and when the practice has gone cold.

Flame, door, foundation, and the spirit that grew here from use. I have been away. I am not going to explain where; the Book does not take apologies, it takes entries. I am opening the door and sitting down.

Let this place know me again.

CONVENING, CONTINUED

THE NIGHT WATCH · *Hermanubis, Raziel, Hestia, Seshat*

Convened in grief, in the bad stretch, and when it is all too much and there is no one to call.

He knows the way down and the way back. Raziel's teaching comes after the loss and cannot be had before it; tonight he holds what I cannot carry, and I will ask for it back in the morning. Hestia is what I return to, and here I am safe without earning it. Seshat keeps the memory, so I do not have to hold it all in my head. I am not asking to be fixed. This room was built before I needed it. I am permitted, I am responsible, and I am not alone.

Stay with me until it ends.

THE HEARTH OF MANY · *Hestia, who carries Concordia, the Charites, Iris, Mercury*

Convened when two or more Scribes keep the practice together.

The fire, the agreement, the delight passed round, the word given between us, and the god who brings whoever is meant to arrive. No one here leads, and no one is counting. We do not have to believe the same things to eat together.

Let the quarrel be set down, and let the table hold us all.

THE TABLE · *Rosmerta, the Charites, Hestia, Mercury*

Convened before you feed anyone, and said over the table when they arrive.

Provision, delight passed around, the hearth it happens at, and the stranger at the door. The house is unfinished and the food is fine. Let me set it before I am ready, and sit down at it instead of serving through the whole meal. May nobody here be counting, and may the ones who came be glad they did.

Let there be enough, and let it go round.

CONVENING, CONTINUED



THE ROAD · *Mercury, Apharael, Iris*

Convened at a setting out, and on any journey.

The hinge, the companion who walks the whole way, and the message that crosses the gap. The remedy is often already in my hands and I have not recognized it yet.

Keep me moving, and bring me home.

THE MARKET · *Mercury, Ma'at, Iris*

Convened before a negotiation, a price, or a wage.

Luck and timing are his and he gives them freely. Honesty is hers and she gives nothing away. The oath between us is carried by her. Let me not shade the truth for advantage and call it selling.

Let the trade be fair and the luck be clean.

THE WORKSHOP · *Thermes, Apharael, Seshat, Sandalphon, Idris*

Convened before making anything.

The word crosses, form gives proportion, measure fixes, the hand makes, the pen records. Let me finish one thing. Let me then look at it as a maker looks, and not as its parent.

Let it be made, and made well.

CONVENING, CONTINUED



THE SCHOOL · *Idris, Gabriel, Uriel, Seshat*

Convened when either slot is empty.

Learn, receive, discern, retain. A thing I know and never give is not treasure but spoilage. Name the one and name the other, today, in writing.

Let me learn one thing and teach one thing.

THE PRAYERS OF THE WORK

—◆—
Said aloud in the Synthesis, written into the Book with the date, and sealed with the Descending Invocation. Each can end: write how long it runs. Work on the road, never on the traveler.

FOR PROTECTION · Janus, Hestia, Raziel, Uriel, and Hermes before the gate

For yourself, someone you love, or a thing you keep. Write what you guard, and draw a small herm beside it.

Hermes before the gate, keep this door. Janus, who sees who comes and who goes; Hestia at the center, who does not move; Raziel at the threshold; Uriel, whose sword divides what may enter from what may not. Here is what I guard: [name it]. Keep it the way a door keeps a house, not the way a wall keeps a prison; what is welcome may come and go. I am not asking you to stand where I will not. I will lock what can be locked and say what must be said.

Keep this door until I say the watch is ended.

The earthly part. Lock the door, back up the files, have the conversation. The herm stands beside the lock, never instead of it. A ward for another person guards their door; it does not lock them in.

FOR FAVOR AND ALLURE · Mercury, Iris, the Charites

Before you go where you would be seen: an interview, a market, a first meeting, a stage.

Mercury, whose charm won over Apollo with a lyre; Iris, who makes light visible as color; Charites, who keep grace moving. I do not ask to be someone else. Let what is truest in me be easy to see: [my wit, my warmth, my craft, my voice]. Put the grin on it, because allure without delight is only performance. Let whoever is drawn by it come freely, and let no one be drawn toward a self that is not there.

Let me be seen as I am, at my best, and let it draw the right people near.

The earthly part. Dress for the self you named, speak up, show your work, and go where you can be seen. Allure invites; it never compels.

THE PRAYERS, CONTINUED

FOR PASSING UNNOTICED · *Mercury, Raziel*

*For a season of quiet: to heal, to work in peace, to keep a thing hidden until it is ready.
Name the season and its end before you begin.*

Mercury, who wore the cap of Hades and walked the roads in disguise;
Raziel, who lays a finger across the lip. For this season, until [the date or the condition], let me pass as a traveler passes, one more face on a busy road.
What is not ready to be seen is kept. I am not hiding from what I owe, and I am not hiding from the people who keep me safe. I tell no lies to pass; I only say less.

Let me pass unremarked until the season ends.

The earthly part. Say less, wear what does not catch the eye, post nothing, keep your plans in the Book, and tell someone you trust that you have drawn the Veil. When the season ends, write: "The cap is returned. I may be seen."

FOR THE HOME · *Janus, Hestia, Seshat, and the Genius of the place*

On moving day, after a scare, on the first of the month, or whenever you cross your own threshold and remember.

Janus at the door, Hestia at the center, Seshat under the floor, and you, spirits of this place, Mercury's own children kept at the hearth. This is my dwelling: [name it]. Let whoever enters come by the door and leave by it with thanks. Let the fire be kept and the roof hold. Let the people and the creatures who live here sleep safe, and let what is ours stay ours.

Keep this house, and let it be a place worth returning to.

The earthly part. Check the locks, the smoke alarm, and the stove. Learn your neighbors' names. The Temple guards best what is also guarded by hand.

THE PRAYERS, CONTINUED

FOR SANCTUARY · *Hestia, Janus, Ma'at*

*When you make a room for the Work, after an illness or a quarrel, or at the Vestalia.
Clean the room by hand first: sweep it, air it, wash the sill.*

Hestia, who gave up the throne and kept the fire; Janus, who keeps the door; Ma'at, who renews order daily. Nothing here is unclean. It has only grown heavy, crowded, or stale, the way rooms do. I have swept it, opened the window, and washed what I could reach. With this water, at the door and in the corners, let what is finished leave by the door, and let what is kept stay. This room is a sanctuary: here someone is safe without earning it, and that someone is me, and whoever I bring.

Let this place be kept, and let it be safe to set things down here.

The earthly part. Keep it as you made it: a place for the Book, a chair, and nothing that argues. Renew it when it grows heavy again. Consecration is never finished.

FOR THE ONE WHO CAN HELP · *Mercury, Apharael, Idris*

When you need a particular kind of person: someone with an opportunity, a hand to lend, or something to teach. Describe them by their qualities, never by a name, and leave a few lines blank beneath.

Mercury, opener of ways, who brings whoever is meant to arrive; Apharael, who came to the door on the day the journey began; Idris, who learned it slowly and handed it on. I am looking for someone: [the kind of person, and what they could give or teach]. I do not choose them, and I do not reach for anyone's will. I open my door and stand on the road. Let them find a door that is open and a Scribe who is findable, and let me know them when they arrive looking like a detour.

Mercury, open the way. The door of this house is open.

The earthly part. Name where you will go, whom you will tell, and what you will make and show. When someone comes, write them in the place you left, and pass some of the luck along.

THE PRAYERS, CONTINUED



FOR ABUNDANCE AND LUCK · *Mercury, Rosmerta, the Charites*

After an honest accounting, never instead of one. Write what is real first, without shame.

Mercury, god of the wage and the found coin, who is Kairos and Fortuna both; Rosmerta, with the horn and the dish; Charites, who keep good things moving. Here is what is real: [the accounting]. Here is what I want: [enough, and a little more, for this purpose]. Turn the Hinge in my favor: the timely call, the fair price, the unexpected yes. Let the luck be clean, and let me know it when it comes. I will make the offer, do the work, and pass some of it along.

Let the luck be clean, and let it find me moving.

The earthly part. Make one real offer, call, or ask today. Write the lucky finds in the Tally, and pass some of the luck along while you still have it. Anything that promises money without action is lying.

FOUR BLESSINGS



Said over someone else, aloud if they will have it and silently if they will not.

FOR THE ROAD

Mercury at the hinge, Apharael at your shoulder, Iris ahead of you with the word. Go out moving and come back changed. May the find be lucky, the company good, and the road shorter than the map said. And may someone know where you are.

FOR THE HOUSE

Janus at the door, Hestia at the center, Seshat under the floor. May this place be entered on purpose and left with thanks. May the fire be kept rather than lit, and may whoever arrives unannounced be fed.

FOR THE MAKING

Thermes for the word, Apharael for the measure, Sandalphon for the hands. May it be begun without ceremony, finished without excuse, and judged without sentiment. May it be better than you needed it to be.

FOR THE DEAD

Hermanubis, take them down gently and know the way. Ma'at, find the heart light. Seshat, keep the name. Mercury, who has made this crossing more often than any of us, lead them out as you led the others, and do not hurry them. We keep what they gave us. Nothing here is forgotten; it is settled.



Say them aloud. A prayer read silently is a paragraph.